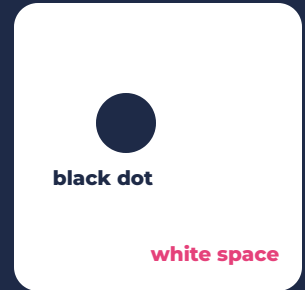


Your students heard it. Now keep it going.

Your students had an assembly with Erin Pompa, and maybe you were in it too. It was all about shifting negative thoughts and not giving in to destructive behavior. The main themes were noticing when black dots happen in your life and shifting your perspective through acceptance and gratitude. So how can you keep these conversations going in your classroom? Below are tons of ideas. Take what you like and leave the rest.



1 Post-presentation reflection

The same day or in the days after the presentation, engage your students in a reflection on Erin's presentation. Here are some questions and ideas.

- 1 What part of the talk stuck with you most?
- 2 What surprised you?
- 3 What's a black dot people our age deal with?
- 4 Where do you see white space in your life right now?
- 5 What has the 80% been telling you lately?
- 6 What's one thing you're grateful for, even when it's hard?
- 7 What would you want your teachers to know about what you heard?
- 8 How can we find white space together as a class?

Teachers, if you attended, please share too. Sit in a circle, break into small groups, do whatever works for your classroom. No one has to share their black dot out loud. If a student needs more support, loop in your counselor or SAC.

For you, as the educator, if you attended the assembly

Ask yourself these questions individually, or reflect on them with your students as well.

- What have you noticed in your students since the assembly?
- Which of these ideas do you need for yourself?
- What's your black dot this year? What do you have despite it?
- How can you model a perspective shift for your students?
- How can you practice acceptance and gratitude in your life and in your classroom?



"If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change."

WAYNE DYER

2 The shared language

Weren't at the assembly? Start here. Your students heard these words in the assembly. Use them in your classroom and revisit them often.

80%

The 80%

Some studies estimate 80% of our thoughts are negative.

"Is that the 80% talking?"



Black dot

The one thing going wrong we can't stop staring at.

"What's your black dot?"



White space

Seeing what you have in the midst of not getting what you want.

"What do you have right now, despite your black dot?"



Perspective

How are you looking at the situation?

"Are you open to seeing it differently?"



Acceptance

Focusing on what's in your power and letting go of what isn't.

"What's in your control? What's not?"



Gratitude

Finding the good when it's hard.

"What's still good?"

3 Ideas for your classroom

Quick ways to keep it going. Use what fits.



Check-in

"1 to 10, how loud is the 80% today?"



After a setback

"This is a black dot. What are you grateful for in spite of it? What's in your control? What's not?"



White space wall

Sticky notes of good things. Add to it all year.



Dot sheet

Black dot in the middle. Fill the white space around it.



Gratitude jar

Drop in one good thing. Read a few on Fridays.



Exit ticket

"I can't control ___, but I can still ___."



80% door meter

A 1 to 10 scale by the door. Students tap their number.



Friday shout-outs

Name someone else's white space from the week.



Turn and talk

Two minutes: black dot, then white space.



Four corners

Black dot, white space, perspective, gratitude. Pick one, say why.

Thank you

Thank you for the work you do, and for allowing Erin to share, learn, and grow with your students. Keep shining. Keep finding your white space. **You deserve it, and your students do too.**